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Shooting rest stabilizer system

Abstract

A shooting rest stabilizer is configured to resist movement of a shooting rest in response to firing of a firearm or weapon supported by the shooting rest. The shooting rest stabilizer includes a base plate having an orifice to receive an adjustment bolt/leg of a shooting rest, a back mounting block engageable to a back support, a front right mounting block engageable to a front right support, and a front left mounting block engageable to a front left support. The supports are securable to a stationary base surface. A front lateral fixture is couplable between the front right and front left supports to receive front legs of the shooting rest. Back, front right, and front left elongate supports are attached between the base plate and respective mounting blocks. The shooting rest stabilizer. A unitary mount support platform includes at least the back, front right, and front left supports.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The present application is a continuation-in-part of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/103,824 filed Nov. 24, 2020, which

claimed the priority benefit of U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 62/954,873, filed Dec. 30, 2019, both of which entitled “System and Method for Increasing Accuracy of Shooter and Firearm,” the contents of both of which are incorporated herein by reference in their entirety for all purposes.

BACKGROUND

1. Technical Field

(1) The present disclosure relates in general to shooting rests for holding a firearm during test firings and measurements.

2. Description of the Related Art

(2) Bench or shooting rests are used to stabilize a firearm or weapon for adjusting and sighting the weapon or optimizing ammunition. The “rests” may absorb the forces originating from the weapon and/or simply allow the weapon to rest upon them, providing a stable location from which to shoot. However, certain movements of the rest relative to the underlying support may be undesirable. In an example, the rest may longitudinally displace as “non-resetting recoil displacement. The distal end of the rest may experience a rest jump. The barrel of the weapon may experience barrel lift, drop, or other movement. The barrel of the weapon may experience a twist within the rest.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(3) In one aspect, the present disclosure provides a shooting rest stabilizer system that has a shooting rest stabilizer including a base plate having an orifice configured to receive a downward projecting rear adjustment bolt or leg of a shooting rest. The shooting rest stabilizer is configured to resist movement of the shooting rest in response to firing of a firearm or weapon supported by the shooting rest. The base plate includes an interface mechanism that is selectively lockable to the adjustment bolt or leg to allow for vertical adjustment of the adjustment bolt or leg. The shooting rest stabilizer includes a back mounting block engageable to a back support. The shooting rest stabilizer includes a front right mounting block engageable to a front right support. The shooting rest stabilizer includes a front left mounting block engageable to a front left support. The back support, the front right support and the front left support are securable to a stationary base surface. The shooting rest stabilizer system includes a front lateral fixture that is couplable between the front right support and the front left support to receive a front right leg and a front left leg of the shooting rest. The shooting rest stabilizer includes a back elongate support attached between a rear edge of the base plate and the back mounting block. The shooting rest stabilizer includes a front right elongate support attached between a front right edge of the base plate and the front right mounting block. The shooting rest stabilizer includes a front left elongate support attached between a left front edge of the base plate and the front left mounting block.

(4) These and other features are explained more fully in the embodiments illustrated below. It should be understood that in general the features of one embodiment also may be used in combination with features of another embodiment and that the embodiments are not intended to limit the scope of the invention.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The description of the illustrative embodiments can be read in conjunction with the accompanying figures. It will be appreciated that for simplicity and clarity of illustration, elements illustrated in the figures have not necessarily been drawn to scale. For example, the dimensions of some of the elements are exaggerated relative to other elements. Embodiments incorporating teachings of the present disclosure are shown and described with respect to the figures presented herein, in which:

(2) FIG. 1 illustrates a system, according to one or more embodiments;

- (3) FIG. 2A is illustrative of a base assembly of a system, according to one or more embodiments;
- (4) FIG. 2B is illustrative of a base assembly of a system, according to one or more embodiments;
- (5) FIG. 2C is illustrative of a dog bone assembly of a system, according to one or more embodiments;
- (6) FIG. 3 is illustrative of a safety lanyard assembly of a system, according to one or more embodiments;
- (7) FIG. 4A is illustrative of a grip/trigger assembly of a system, according to one or more embodiments;
- (8) FIG. 4B is illustrative of a trigger guard gripper of a system, according to one or more embodiments;
- (9) FIG. 4C is illustrative of trigger engagement subassembly of a system, according to one or more embodiments;
- (10) FIG. 5A is illustrative of a remote trigger assembly of a system, according to one or more embodiments;
- (11) FIG. 5B is illustrative of a remote pistol grip assembly of a system, according to one or more embodiments;
- (12) FIG. 6 is illustrative of a forend assembly of a system, according to one or more embodiments;
- (13) FIG. 7 is illustrative of a stock cradle assembly of a system, according to one or more embodiments;
- (14) FIG. 8 is illustrative of a grip cradle assembly of a system, according to one or more embodiments;
- (15) FIG. 9 is illustrative of a Picatinny-style mount of a system, according to one or more embodiments;
- (16) FIG. 10 is illustrative of a data collection environment, according to one or more embodiments;
- (17) FIG. 11 is illustrative of a data collection environment, according to one or more embodiments;
- (18) FIG. 12 is illustrative of a data collection environment, according to one or more embodiments;
- (19) FIG. 13 is illustrative of a data collection environment, according to one or more embodiments;
- (20) FIGS. 14A-14D are illustrative respectively of a Phase I-IV data collection environments, according to one or more embodiments;
- (21) FIG. 15 is a side view of the conventional shooting rest that is annotated with movement that occurs without stabilization;
- (22) FIG. 16 is an isometric exploded view of a shooting rest stabilizer below a rifle on a shooting rest and above a shooting rest mount, according to one or more embodiments;
- (23) FIGS. 17A-17C are isometric, top, and side views of the shooting rest stabilizer of FIG. 16, according to one or more embodiments;
- (24) FIGS. 18A-18C are isometric, top, and side views of the shooting rest stabilizer system having the shooting rest stabilizer attached to the shooting rest mount and to the shooting rest of FIG. 16, according to one or more embodiments;
- (25) FIGS. 18A-18C are side, top and front views of the assembled shooting rest stabilizer, rifle, shooting rest, and shooting rest mount, according to one or more embodiments;
- (26) FIG. 19 is an isometric view of an example unitary shooting rest mount, according to one or more embodiments;
- (27) FIG. 20 is a side view of the shooting rest stabilizer system having an example unitary shooting rest mount of FIG. 19 configured with ground mounting screws, according to one or more embodiments;
- (28) FIG. 21 is an isometric view of the example unitary shooting rest mount of FIG. 19 with a

front truck bed fixture, according to one or more embodiments;

(29) FIG. 22 is a side view of the shooting rest stabilizer system having the example unitary shooting rest mount of FIG. 21 with the truck bed fixture secured to a truck bed of a truck vehicle, according to one or more embodiments;

(30) FIG. 23 is an isometric view of an example unitary shooting rest mount of FIG. 19 with a front fixture further configured with two ground supports and a hitch fixture for mounting to a vehicle draw bar, according to one or more embodiments;

(31) FIG. 24 is a side view of the example unitary shooting rest mount of FIG. 23 mounted to a vehicle draw bar of a vehicle and supporting a firearm or weapon and shooting rest that is stabilized with the shooting rest stabilizer, according to one or more embodiments;

(32) FIG. 25 is an isometric view of an example unitary shooting rest mount of FIG. 19 with a rear ground stand and a front bracket fixture, according to one or more embodiments; and

(33) FIG. 26 is a side view of the example unitary shooting rest mount of FIG. 25 having the front bracket fixture secured to a bench platform and supporting a firearm or weapon and shooting rest that is stabilized with the shooting rest stabilizer, according to one or more embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(34) According to aspects of the present disclosure, a shooting rest stabilizer is attachable to a bench or shooting rest and to stationary or static surface (e.g., ground covering, anchored table, etc.). The shooting rest, or merely “rest”, may be according to aspects of the present disclosure provided herein or may be a conventional bench/shooting rest with typical components. When fired, a firearm or weapon creates a variety of static forces and kinetic motion. When the weapon is placed and secured in the shooting rest, the motion from the weapon when firing is taken into account by the shooting rest. In particular, when the weapon is fired, slides, bearings, springs, hydraulic cylinders, and other commonly used devices of the shooting rest ensure that the weapon is held firmly while mitigating the recoil physics exhibited by the weapon and while being retained by the shooting rest.

(35) The shooting rest stabilizer may be sized and configured for use in conjunction with prior art shooting and/or bench rests or for embodiments described herein according to the present disclosure. The shooting rest stabilizer may include the following elements all part of the same assembly or system. An interface selectively unlocks to a shooting rest to enable adjustment to a position in space as needed, then locked into a non-moving position onto a base plate. Base plate provides proximal receptacles or mounting points required by supports. Supports provide competing compression and expansion forces to base plate to dampen oscillations and are distally attached respectively to mounting blocks. Mounting blocks are attachable to a fixed, rigid, static body such as the static body. In one or more embodiments, a support bar suspended between supports toward the front supports for stability. In one or more embodiments, each support is expandable and compressible to compensate for the position in three-dimensional space for the base plate. The supports provide simultaneous compression and expansion of which creates a pre-loaded condition to reduce movement of bench/shooting rest.

(36) According to other aspects of the present disclosure, a system and method for increasing performance of shooter and firearm is provided. The present disclosure provides for a system comprising an operator device configured to receive and transmit one or more data sets over a network and a server and data management module configured to receive and transmit one or more data sets over a network. The server and data management module further comprises a registration customer service submodule and a partner services submodule.

(37) In another embodiment, the present disclosure provides for a system comprising a base assembly, a safety lanyard assembly, a grip/trigger assembly, a remote trigger assembly, a forend assembly, a stock assembly, a grip cradle subassembly, and a Picatinny-style mount. The base assembly further comprises a dog bone assembly, a longitudinal rail assembly, and a plurality of swivel leveling mounts affixed to a plate of the dog bone assembly.

(38) The stock assembly is operably connected to the longitudinal rail assembly and comprises a stock cradle, a brace, a first extension tube and a second extension tube, a plate configured to couple the first and second extension tubes, and a link base configured to connect the brace with the first and second extension tubes.

(39) A grip/trigger assembly is operably connected to the longitudinal rail assembly and further comprises an adjustable upright grip/trigger tower affixed to the longitudinal rail assembly via a corner brace, a trigger guard holding mechanism affixed to the adjustable upright grip/trigger tower, a trigger guard gripper affixed to the trigger guard holding mechanism, a grip cradle subassembly, and a trigger engagement mechanism, part of the remote trigger assembly, affixed to the longitudinal rail assembly, comprises a plurality of gears configured to engage a trigger when activated.

(40) A forend assembly is operably connected to the longitudinal rail assembly and further comprises an adjustable upright forend tower affixed to the longitudinal rail assembly via a corner brace, and a forend clamp mechanism, which is affixed to the adjustable upright forend tower. A Picatinny-style mount maybe alternatively and operably connected to the adjustable upright forend tower instead of the forend clamp mechanism.

(41) A remote trigger assembly comprises a trigger engagement subassembly operably connected to the longitudinal rail assembly and comprises a plurality of gears configured to engage a trigger when activated is operably connected to remote pistol grip assembly comprises a remote pistol grip, a trigger handle, a pin, and a spring, coupled to a holder and a cable where the cable is further affixed to the pin.

(42) A safety lanyard assembly comprises a lanyard, a pin operably connected to the lanyard via a cable, and an anchor end, where the anchor end is operably coupled to the longitudinal rail assembly. The pin is inserted into the remote pistol grip to prevent unintended operation when not ready to fire the firearm.

(43) The system and method disclosed herein are configured for use by consumers (for recreational, competition, and long-range/high accuracy), manufacturers (for research and development R&D/D, test, and QA/QC), and/or for use by first responders, law-enforcement, and the military. The system and method are designed to be compatible with all manufactured firearms and for use by operators with a wide variety of skill level and experience.

(44) In one or more embodiments, the present disclosure provides a rig configured so as to hold a firearm in place, having a rig sensor suite including a plurality of sensors including a base sensor, a top of rail sensor, a stock sensor, a grip trigger sensor, and a forend sensor. In one or more embodiments, the present disclosure provides an operator sensor suite including at least four different pressure, orientation, displacement, acceleration, or position sensors including a chest pad sensor, a head sensor, a grip trigger sensor, and a forend sensor. In one or more embodiments, the present disclosure provides a first extension tube and a second extension tube, a plate configured to couple the first and second extension tubes, and a link base configured to connect the brace with the first and second extension tubes.

(45) References within the specification to “one embodiment,” “an embodiment,” “embodiments”, or “one or more embodiments” are intended to indicate that a particular feature, structure, or characteristic described in connection with the embodiment is included in at least one embodiment of the present disclosure. The appearance of such phrases in various places within the specification are not necessarily all referring to the same embodiment, nor are separate or alternative embodiments mutually exclusive of other embodiments. Further, various features are described which may be exhibited by some embodiments and not by others. Similarly, various requirements are described which may be requirements for some embodiments but not other embodiments.

(46) It is understood that the use of specific component, device and/or parameter names and/or corresponding acronyms thereof, such as those of the executing utility, logic, and/or firmware described herein, are for example only and not meant to imply any limitations on the described

embodiments. The embodiments may thus be described with different nomenclature and/or terminology utilized to describe the components, devices, parameters, methods and/or functions herein, without limitation. References to any specific protocol or proprietary name in describing one or more elements, features or concepts of the embodiments are provided solely as examples of one implementation, and such references do not limit the extension of the claimed embodiments to embodiments in which different element, feature, protocol, or concept names are utilized. Thus, each term utilized herein is to be given its broadest interpretation given the context in which that term is utilized.

(47) Reference will now be made in detail to the embodiments of the present disclosure, examples of which are illustrated in the accompanying drawings. Wherever possible, the same reference numbers will be used throughout the specification to refer to the same or like parts.

(48) The present disclosure provides for a complete ecosystem, comprising software, hardware, and intelligence gathering in the form of data from a rig and/or operator. Each component of the ecosystem provides advantages over the prior art not only as part of the ecosystem as a whole, but also as individual elements. The ecosystem: (1) creates a user community and provides opportunities for receiving relevant content (such as advertising, retailer links, and other valuable content); (2) provides opportunities for engaging with other users (i.e., forum, contests and game); (3) provides opportunities for engaging with instructors and trainers; (4) provides opportunities for advertisers to reach these users with targeted messages or sponsorship; and (5) provides opportunities for manufacturers of firearms, firearm components/accessories/performance features, and ammunition as well as operator accessories and performance features to share data. Any/all these opportunities may be gained locally or at a remote location/distance.

(49) The present disclosure provides for a system and method for measuring and characterizing the performance of a shooter, with and/or without accessories and/or performance features, and one or more associated firearms, with and/or without accessories and/or performance features and making recommendations for improving the performance of each. Software may enable the connection between hardware (the rig) and operator via one or more sensor(s) suites to enable data gathering from the rig and/or operator and feedback (via direct or indirect means) to be provided regarding each and/or both. In one embodiment, the sensor(s) suite may comprise use of a LASER for alignment and LIDAR for displacement measurements among the other sensors within the sensor suite, and combinations thereof.

(50) For example, the software may enable one or more data sets to be collected from the rig and/or the operator and processing this data to determine a target position for the rig and/or the operator. The software may also enable additional data sets to be collected each time the operator uses the rig or firearm or steps into position to shoot. Such software may process the data collected from the various sensor(s) suites and compare the data with the target position saved for the rig and/or operator. This comparison may generate a number of different notifications to the user such as: (1) how far off their current rig and/or operator position is from the target position; and (2) what adjustments should be made correct their stance, firearm alignment, and/or body alignment so that the rig and operator are in the target position. Once an operator has fired the firearm, the software may enable the collection of post-firing data such as accuracy to target, providing immediate feedback on performance to enable the operator to make the necessary adjustments, as well as firearm and accessory information such as performance and predictive/preventative service and maintenance.

(51) The present disclosure provides for an improved rig design that is configured so as to hold a firearm in place at the same points as an operator while returning the firearm to an original resting start position that is practically impossible for a human to accomplish after each cycle of operations of the firearm. Such positioning enables the most realistic and accurate data matching in terms of performance and can be used to generate data related to firearm performance managing predicted maintenance and service and preventing firearm failure. Due to the flexibility and modular nature

of the rig design, it can be easily manipulated to hold a wide variety of different types of firearms and provides for uncorrupted operation of the firearm including ammunition and magazine changes. The design allows the firearm to operate as designed with translation and recoil mitigation. In one embodiment, the hardware is also configured with a variable recoil system that matches the platform while considering a “return to battery” and human retention and response. Unlike systems of the prior art, the present rig design does not rely on a mounted optic element as the centroid element.

(52) It is also contemplated that the system of the present disclosure can be used in an indoor or an outdoor environment and can be used with a single user or configured with interconnectivity so that multiple users can interact while using the system, such as for competition or gaming.

(53) The design also enables magazine changes without removing the firearm and does not touch the barrel but allows any/all barrels to float freely. In one embodiment, actual recoil may be measured by determining the mass of the firearm by first measuring the entire mass of the rig with the firearm in-place, then subtracting/taring the constant or known weight of the rig and applying $F=MA$ to the displacement and accelerometric data and physically measuring the actual recoil compared with the data obtained through the sensor(s) suite in the stock cradle assembly used to determine felt (or measurable) recoil.

(54) The combination of software and hardware enables robust intelligence gathering to support a complete ecosystem including firearms platforms (and their manufacturers of firearms, firearm components/accessories/performance features, and ammunition), as well as their operators and other individuals. Such an ecosystem may support targeted marketing campaigns by retailers, virtual competitions between rigs, and/or operators, and valuable operability information to manufacturers regarding the firearms, accessories, and components they manufacture. Examples of data that may be generated include, but are not limited to: (a) Matching the best ammunition for a particular firearm. (b) Enabling efficient and effective recalls for firearms and accessories based on firearm platform and operator performance data. (c) Setting alerts and notifications for predictive maintenance for firearm and accessories. (d) Setting alerts and notifications for operational reminders. (e) Allowing data to be collected and assessed across multiple users. (f) Enabling baselines to be established for firearms and operators. (g) Measure shooting accuracy, distance between shots, distance to target, and other measurable results to enable users to make improvements and permit competition among various users. (h) Correlate data of the operator to various demographic data sets. (i) Setting alerts and notifications for scheduling shooting reminders to maintain consistent practice schedule in order to retain performance improvements. (j) Provide sanitized demographic and geographic intelligence to advertisers. (k) Assisting the manufacturers of firearms, firearm components/accessories/performance features, and ammunition, to produce the best product match to market.

(55) Referring now to the drawings, FIG. 1 is illustrative of a system of the present disclosure. The system **100** comprises a plurality of assemblies and subassemblies which are operably connected to enable operation of the system **100**. These assemblies and subassemblies include a base assembly **200**, a safety lanyard assembly **300**, a grip/trigger assembly **400**, a remote pistol grip assembly **500**, a forend assembly **600**, a stock cradle assembly **700**, a grip cradle subassembly **800**, and a Picatinny-style mount **900**. Each of the foregoing assemblies and subassemblies are described in more detail below.

(56) The base assembly **200** is illustrated in detail in FIGS. 2A-2C. As seen in the figures, the base assembly comprises a plurality of swivel leveling mounts **202a**, **202b**, and **202c** which serve as a foundation for the system **100** and also provide for an adjusting mechanism that can be used to adjust the overall height of the system **100** or to adjust the height of one part of the system **100** to account for uneven terrain. The swivel leveling mounts **202a**, **202b**, and **202c** are each affixed to a plate **210** of a dog bone assembly **204**. The dog bone assembly is illustrated in FIG. 2C. A plurality of eye nuts **206a**, **206b**, **206c**, and **206d** are also affixed to the plate **210** of the dog bone assembly

204. The dog bone assembly **204** is operably coupled to a longitudinal rail assembly **208**. The plate **210** also comprises a bull's eye level **212** and a plurality of knurled knob assemblies **214a** and **214b** which are used to affix each of the swivel leveling mounts to the plate **210**. A recoil spring **216** is further affixed to the longitudinal rail assembly **208** and to the dog bone assembly **204** to allow the linear translation of the longitudinal rail assembly **208** and to return it to rest under (adjustable for a wide range of recoil pressure) spring tension.

(57) The system further comprises a safety lanyard assembly **300** which is illustrated in FIG. 3. The safety lanyard assembly **300** comprises a lanyard **302** with a pin **304** and an anchor end **306**, where the anchor end is configured to be operably coupled to the longitudinal rail assembly **208** using plurality of washers and button head cap screw. The pin **304** is operably coupled to the remote pistol grip subassembly **502** to prevent unintended operation.

(58) The system **100** further comprises a grip/trigger assembly **400** which is operably connected to the longitudinal rail assembly **208** of base assembly **200**. The grip/trigger assembly is illustrated by FIGS. 4A-4C and comprises an upright grip/trigger tower **412** is affixed to the longitudinal rail assembly **208** of base assembly **200** via a corner brace **410** and may be adjusted via a plurality of nuts and bolts **408** to achieve the desired height of the grip/trigger assembly **400**. The upright grip/trigger tower **412** is affixed to a trigger guard holding mechanism **402** using an adjusting rod **404**, end cap **406** and washer **414**. The grip/trigger assembly **400** further comprises a trigger guard gripper **416** connected to a block **420** using a brace **418** and a button head cap screw **422**.

(59) The trigger pull assembly **400A** illustrated by FIG. 4C further comprises a trigger engagement mechanism **434** affixed to a trigger engagement bar (contains a plurality of nuts and washers and bolt contained within a spring **432**). A plurality of gears, comprising a top gear **430** and a bottom gear **428** are operably connected and configured so as to enable the trigger engagement mechanism **434** to engage when activated. The plurality of gears **430** and **428** are affixed to a plate **436** which is used as a mount for the plurality of gears **430**. A cable holder **426** may be used to affix the plurality of gears **430** and **428** to the plate **436** and the plate **436** may be further affixed to an upright member **424**. This upright member **424** may be further affixed to the grip/trigger assembly **400** and to the longitudinal rail assembly **208** of base assembly **200**.

(60) The system **100** further comprises a remote pistol grip assembly **500** which is illustrated in FIGS. 5A-5B. The remote pistol grip assembly **500** is configured to enable remote operation of the system **100** and firing of a firearm. The remote pistol grip assembly comprises a remote pistol grip **502** and a trigger handle **504**. A pin **506** allows trigger handle **504** to pivot. A spring **508** is coupled to a holder **526** and cable **524**, where the cable **524** is further affixed to gear **428** through holder **426**. A plurality of screws **518**, **520**, **510**, **512**, and **516** are used to secure the elements of the remote pistol grip assembly.

(61) Referring now to FIG. 6, the system **100** further comprises a forend assembly **600** which is operably connected to the longitudinal rail assembly **208** of base assembly **200**. The forend assembly **600** comprises a corner brace **616** affixed to an upright forend tower **606** using a plurality of nuts **602** and **604** and socket head cap screws. The upright forend tower **606** is operably connected to a forend cradle clamp mechanism **614** using an adjusting rod **610**, washer **612**, and end cap **608**. The forend cradle clamp mechanism **614** may be adjusted as necessary to accommodate a wide variety of different firearms.

(62) The system **100** further comprises a stock assembly **700**, illustrated by FIG. 7, which is operably connected to the longitudinal rail assembly **208** of base assembly **200**. The stock cradle assembly **700** comprises a first extension tube **702** and a second extension tube **704** coupled using a plate **706** and link base **708** to a brace **714** via lock assembly **710**. A stock cradle **712** is affixed to the brace **714** using a mounting mechanism. The stock cradle may comprise one or more swivel pads and thumb screws that can be adjusted to accommodate a wide variety of different firearm stocks. In one embodiment a Rosetta joint may be used to affix the brace **714** to the first and second extension tubes **702** and **704** respectively, to provide a means for further adjusting the stock cradle

assembly in detent/positive-locking and rotational positions to accommodate a wide variety of different firearm stocks.

(63) FIG. 8 is illustrative of a grip cradle subassembly **800** which is operably connected to the adjustable upright grip/trigger tower **412**. The grip cradle subassembly **800** further comprises a support axle **804** connected to two side supports **808**. Each side support **808** is affixed to a grip cradle **806** which is configured to house a plurality of clamps **810a**, **810b**, and **810c** to conform to and accommodate a wide variety of firearm grips. Each clamp further comprises one or more springs **802**. FIG. 9 is illustrative of a Picatinny-style mount **900** comprising block **902** affixed to a locking plate **906**. The locking plate is affixed to the block **902** using a plurality of washers and screws **904a** and **904b**. This mount can be affixed to adjustable upright forend tower **606** and used alternatively in place of/instead of forend cradle clamp mechanism **614**.

(64) The present disclosure also provides for a system **1000**. This ecosystem is illustrated by FIGS. **10-13**. Turning first to FIG. **10**, which illustrates an embodiment of the ecosystem, the system **1000** comprises an operator device **1002** configured to receive and transmit one or more data sets over a network **1006** and a server and data management module **1008** also configured to receive one or more data sets over a network. The service and data management module **1008** further comprises a registration customer service submodule **1010** and a partner services submodule **1012**. The registration customer service submodule **1010** may be used to collect and transmit data from the operator and the partner services submodule **1012** may be used to collect and transmit data from one or more industry partners. In one embodiment the system **1000** further comprises a camera target **1004** configured to interact with the operator device **1002**.

(65) In another embodiment, illustrated by FIG. **11**, the system **1000** further comprises an electronics management module **1016** which comprises a power source **1018**, a processor **1020**, and a communications submodule **1022**. The system **1000** also comprises a rig sensor suite **1024** comprising a plurality of sensors affixed to at least one of an operator and a rig, where the rig sensor suite is operably coupled to the electronics management module **1016** and is configured to collect one or more data sets from at least one of the operator via the operator device **1002** and the rig. The rig sensor suite **1024** further comprises a plurality of different sensors including: (1) a base sensor **1026** configured to receive one or more data sets associated with at least one of temperature, relative humidity, sound, light, alignment, mass vibration, signals, and alerts; (2) a top of rail sensor **1028** configured to receive one or more data sets associated with at least one of position, orientation, velocity, and acceleration; (3) a stock sensor **1030** configured to receive one or more data sets associated with at least one of pressure, position, and orientation; (4) a grip trigger sensor **1032** configured to receive one or more data sets associated with pressure, position, and orientation, and a forend sensor **1034** configured to receive one or more data sets associated with at least one of pressure, position, and orientation. In the embodiment of FIG. **11**, the server and data management module **1008** may further comprise a rig data submodule **1014** configured to process one or more data sets received from the rig sensor suite.

(66) In another embodiment, illustrated by FIG. **12**, the system **1000** further comprises an operator sensor suite **1036**, where the operator sensor suite **1036** further comprises a plurality of different sensors including: (1) a chest pad sensor **1038** configured to receive one or more data sets associated with at least one of pressure, orientation, and displacement; (2) a head sensor **1040** configured to receive one or more data sets associated with at least one of orientation, acceleration and displacement; (3) a grip trigger sensor **1042** configured to receive one or more data sets associated with at least one of pressure, position, and orientation; and (4) a forend sensor **1044** configured to receive one or more data sets associated with at least one of pressure, position, and orientation.

(67) In another embodiment, illustrated by FIG. **13**, the server and data management module **1008** further comprises an operator data submodule **1046** configured to process one or more data sets received from the operator device **1002**. In yet another embodiment, the server and data

management module **1008** further comprises comparative data submodule configured to process one or more data sets by applying an algorithm to compare the data sets to one or more baselines. (68) FIGS. **14A-14D** are illustrative of a data collection environment of the present disclosure. FIG. **14A** is a Phase I of data collection environment **1401** that includes user entered data operation (block **1402**). An operator can enter data in block **1402** using an operator device. In one embodiment, the operator device may comprise a smart device or a computer such as a desktop or laptop. This operator data may be sanitized and encrypted at the data preparation block **1404**. In one embodiment, data may also be collected and transmitted using a camera target block **1405**, but such use is not required. Once the data is prepared at block **1404**, the data is transmitted over a network **1006** with registration data (block **1406**) such as customer service, use guidance, etc. Partners (block **1408**) such as advertisers, promotional entities, venue managers, etc., may also communicatively coupled via network **1006**.

(69) FIG. **14B** is a Phase II data collection environment **1411** that includes the features of Phase I data collection environment **1401** (FIG. **14A**). Rig sensors (block **1412**) does pre-processing and conditioning of sensor data and communicatively coupled to blocks **1402** and **1404**. Phase II Rig server (block **1414**) provides an algorithm and database and is communicatively coupled to blocks **1406** and **1408**.

(70) FIG. **14C** is a Phase III data collection environment **1421** that includes the features of Phase II data collection environment **1411** (FIG. **14B**). Instead of rig sensors (block **1412** of FIG. **14B**) operator sensors (block **1416**) does pre-processing and conditioning of sensor data and is communicatively coupled to blocks **1402**, **1404** and **1405**. Phase III backend system **1416** includes Phase II Rig server (block **1414**) and Phase III operator server (block **1418**) that provide an algorithm and database and are communicatively coupled to blocks **1406** and **1408**.

(71) FIG. **14D** is a Phase IV data collection environment **1431** that includes the features of Phase III data collection environment **1421** (FIG. **14C**). Operator sensors (block **1416**) are communicatively coupled to blocks **1402**, **1404** and **1405**. Rig operator sensors (block **1412**) are communicatively coupled to blocks **1404** and **1405**. Phase IV backend system **1420** includes Phase II Rig server (block **1414**), Phase III operator server (block **1418**), and Phase IV comparative server (block **1422**) that provide an algorithm and database and are communicatively coupled to blocks **1406** and **1408**.

(72) In alternative embodiments, additional data sets may be collected and transmitted using a plurality of rig sensors (block **1412**) and operator sensors (block **1416**). Registration data (block **1406**), data collected from industry partners **1408**, and data from a plurality of rig sensors may also be collected and transmitted via the network **1006** to the operator. Combined rig sensors **1412** and operator sensors **1416** may also be implemented on one embodiment. Comparative data from block **1422** may also be used in analyzing data obtained from an operator and/or a rig to determine thresholds and baselines relevant for providing performance feedback to the operator. There are a couple options for using comparison data: Assist operator to determine if they are performing better or worse relative to previous times; Assist operator to compare their performance to other operators using various categories such as demographic, firearm, distance, etc.

Shooting Rest Stabilizer

(73) FIG. **15** is a side view of a conventional shooting rest **1502** that is annotated with undesirable movement that occurs without stabilization. It is common for the shooting rest **1502** without benefit of the present disclosure to provide undesirable movement, affecting the operational physics of the weapon **1504**, thereby compromising performance (defined as repeatable precision). In an example, the shooting rest **1502** may longitudinally displace as “non-resetting recoil displacement” as depicted at arrow **1506**. The distal end of the shooting rest **1502** may experience a rest jump as depicted at arrow **1508**. The barrel of the weapon **1504** may experience a barrel lift as depicted at arrow **1510**. The barrel of the weapon may experience a twist within the shooting rest **1502** as depicted at **1512**.

(74) FIG. 16 is an isometric exploded view of a stabilized shooting rest system 1600 that includes a shooting rest stabilizer 1602 above a shooting rest mount assembly 1604. When assembled, the shooting rest stabilizer 1602 stabilizes the shooting rest 1502 to the shooting rest mount assembly 1604. In particular, the shooting rest stabilizer is configured to resist movement of the shooting rest 1502 in response to firing of a firearm or weapon (1504) supported by the shooting rest 1502. The shooting rest mount assembly 1604 includes a back support 1606, a front right support 1607 and a front left support 1608, at least one of which are individually or collectively secured to a stationary ground surface 1610 to form a supporting assembly. In alternate embodiments described below, a shooting rest mount assembly includes structures connecting the back support 1606, the front right support 1607 and the front left support 1608 to create a unitary supporting platform. A front lateral fixture 1612 of the stabilized shooting rest system 1600 is coupled directly or indirectly to the front right and left supports 1607 and 1608 to support front right leg 1614 and front left leg 1615 of the shooting rest 1502.

(75) FIGS. 17A-17C are isometric, top, and side views of the shooting rest stabilizer 1602 of FIG. 16. With particular reference to FIG. 16, the shooting rest stabilizer 1602 includes a base plate 1620 having an orifice 1622 provide a rear attachment mechanism of the shooting rest stabilizer 1602 configured to receive a downward projecting rear adjustment bolt or leg 1624 of the shooting rest 1502. Legs of the shooting rest 1502 may or may not include a rear adjustment mechanism 1625 for adjustment and any adjustment would be independent of adjustment provided by the shooting rest stabilizer 1602. The base plate 1620 includes an interface mechanism 1625 that is selectively lockable to the adjustment bolt or leg 1624 to allow for vertical adjustment of the adjustment bolt or leg 1624. The shooting rest stabilizer 1602 includes a back mounting block 1626 engageable to a back support 1606. The shooting rest stabilizer 1602 includes a front right mounting block 1627 engageable to a front right support 1607. The shooting rest stabilizer 1602 includes a front left mounting block 1628 engageable to a front left support 1608. In one or more embodiment, the back support 1606, the front right support 1607 and the front left support 1608 are individually or collectively securable to a stationary ground surface 1610. The shooting rest stabilizer 1602 includes a back elongate support 1632 attached between a rear edge of the base plate 1620 and the back mounting block 1626. The shooting rest stabilizer 1602 includes a front right elongate support 1633 attached between a front right edge of the base plate 1620 and the front right mounting block 1607. A front left elongate support 1634 is attached between a left front edge of the base plate 1620 and the front left mounting block 1628.

(76) In one or more embodiments, each of the back elongate support 1632, the front right elongate support 1633, and the front left elongate support 1634 of the shooting rest stabilizer 1602 include a length adjustment mechanism that is a linearly expandable and compressible to impart a stabilizing force on the base plate. In one or more alternate embodiments, each of the back elongate support 1632, the front right elongate support 1633, and the front left elongate support 1634 of the shooting rest stabilizer 1602 include a telescoping length adjustment mechanism that is selectively longitudinally adjustable to accommodate spacing between the base plate 1620 and a corresponding one of the back support 1606, the front right support 1607 and the front left support 1608 and selectively engageable to a fixed length for use.

(77) With particular reference to FIG. 17C, in one or more embodiments, each of the back elongate support 1632, the front right elongate support 1633, and the front left elongate support 1634 (FIG. 16) of the shooting rest stabilizer 1602 are at least vertically pivotably attached to the base plate 1620 to facilitate positioning of the base plate 1620 above the back elongate support 1632, the front right elongate support 1633, and the front left elongate support 1634 (FIG. 16) for increased stability.

(78) FIGS. 18A-18C are isometric, top, and side views of the stabilized shooting rest system 1600 supporting and stabilizing the shooting rest 1502 of FIG. 16. With particular reference to FIG. 18B, the shooting rest stabilizer 1602 further includes a back clamp 1802 attached to the back mounting

block **1626** and vertically adjustable and selectively engageable to the back support **1606** that extends vertically upward. The shooting rest stabilizer **1602** further includes a front right clamp **1803** attached to the front right mounting block **1627** and vertically adjustable and selectively engageable to the front right support that extends vertically upward. The shooting rest stabilizer **1602** further includes a front left clamp **1804** attached to the front left mounting block **1628** and vertically adjustable and selectively engageable to the front left support **1608** that extends vertically upward.

(79) FIG. **19** is an isometric view of an example unitary shooting rest mount platform **1604a** that includes the back support **1606**, the front right support **1607** and the front left support **1608** all connected by being attached to a T-shaped connecting structure **1902**.

(80) FIG. **20** is a side view of a stabilized shooting rest system **1600** supporting and stabilizing the shooting rest **1502** of FIG. **16** and including an example unitary shooting rest mount platform **1604b** that includes all of the components of example unitary shooting rest mount platform **1604a** of FIG. **19**. In addition, the unitary shooting rest mount platform **1604b** is configured with ground mounting stakes or screws **2002**.

(81) FIG. **21** is an isometric view of an example unitary shooting rest mount platform **1604c** that includes the components of the unitary shooting rest mount platform **1604a** of FIG. **19** and additionally includes a truck bed fixture **2102**.

(82) FIG. **22** is a side view of the shooting rest stabilizer system **1600** having the example unitary shooting rest mount platform **1604c** with the front truck fixture **2102** directly securing the shooting rest stabilizer system **1600** to a truck vehicle **2204**, which in turn indirectly secures to the stationary ground surface **1610**.

(83) FIG. **23** is an isometric view of an example unitary shooting rest mount platform **1604d** that has the components of unitary shooting rest mount platform **1604a** of FIG. **19**. Additionally, example unitary shooting rest mount platform **1604d** includes a back hitch drawbar **2302** engageable to a vehicle hitch **2304**. Example unitary shooting rest mount platform **1604d** includes a front right ground support **2306** and a front left ground support **2307**.

(84) FIG. **24** is a side view of the shooting rest stabilizer system **1600** having the example unitary shooting rest mount platform **1604d** secured to the vehicle hitch **2304** of a vehicle **2402**. The shooting rest stabilizer system **1600** is supporting and stabilizing the shooting rest **1502** that holds the weapon **1504**.

(85) FIG. **25** is an isometric view of an example unitary shooting rest mount platform **1604e** having a T-shaped connecting table **2502** that supports from below a back support **2506**, a front right support **2507** and a front left support **2508** with a rear ground stand **2510** extending downward below the back support **2506**. Forward projecting fasteners **2512** from a forward edge **2514** of the T-shaped connecting table **2502** are received in corresponding vertical slots **2516** in a front lateral fixture **2518** having a lower backward directed flange **2520** that is vertically adjustable relative to the T-shaped connecting table **2502**. A pair of parallel longitudinal slots **2522** formed through the T-shaped connecting table **2502** rearward to the front right support **2507** and the front left support **2508** receive fasteners **2524** attached to an opposing mid bracket **2526** extending vertically and laterally beneath the T-shaped connecting table **2502** and having a forward lower flange **2528**. The opposing mid bracket **2526** is positionable longitudinally rearward and forward.

(86) FIG. **26** is a side view of the shooting rest stabilizer system **1600** including the example unitary shooting rest mount platform **1604e** adjusted to secure to a bench platform **2602**. Rear ground stand **2510** is adjusted in height to place T-shaped connecting table **2502** horizontally on top of bench platform **2602**. Front lateral fixture **2518** and opposing mid bracket **2526** are adjusted to secure a forward portion T-shaped connecting table **2502** to the bench platform **2602**. The shooting rest stabilizer system **1600** is supporting and stabilizing the shooting rest **1502** that holds the weapon **1504**.

(87) While the disclosure has been described in detail in reference to specific embodiments thereof,

it will be apparent to one skilled in the art that various changes and modifications can be made therein without departing from the spirit and scope of the embodiments. Additionally, while the examples provided herein related to specific analytes, the present disclosure is not limited to these analytes and may be used to detect a wide variety of analytes of interest. Thus, it is intended that the present disclosure cover the modifications and variations of this disclosure provided they come within the scope of the appended claims and their equivalents.

(88) While the disclosure has been described with reference to exemplary embodiments, it will be understood by those skilled in the art that various changes may be made, and equivalents may be substituted for elements thereof without departing from the scope of the disclosure. In addition, many modifications may be made to adapt a particular system, device or component thereof to the teachings of the disclosure without departing from the essential scope thereof. Therefore, it is intended that the disclosure is not limited to the particular embodiments disclosed for carrying out this disclosure, but that the disclosure will include all embodiments falling within the scope of the appended claims. Moreover, the use of the terms first, second, etc. do not denote any order or importance, but rather the terms first, second, etc. are used to distinguish one element from another.

(89) The terminology used herein is for the purpose of describing particular embodiments only and is not intended to be limiting of the disclosure. As used herein, the singular forms “a”, “an” and “the” are intended to include the plural forms as well, unless the context clearly indicates otherwise. It will be further understood that the terms “comprises” and/or “comprising,” when used in this specification, specify the presence of stated features, integers, steps, operations, elements, and/or components, but do not preclude the presence or addition of one or more other features, integers, steps, operations, elements, components, and/or groups thereof.

(90) The description of the present disclosure has been presented for purposes of illustration and description but is not intended to be exhaustive or limited to the disclosure in the form disclosed. Many modifications and variations will be apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art without departing from the scope of the disclosure. The described embodiments were chosen and described in order to best explain the principles of the disclosure and the practical application, and to enable others of ordinary skill in the art to understand the disclosure for various embodiments with various modifications as are suited to the particular use contemplated.

Claims

1. A shooting rest stabilizer system comprising: a shooting rest stabilizer comprising: a base plate having an orifice configured to receive a downward projecting rear adjustment bolt or leg of a shooting rest, the base plate comprising an interface mechanism selectively lockable to the adjustment bolt or leg to allow for vertical adjustment of the adjustment bolt or leg; a back mounting block engageable to a back support, a front right mounting block engageable to a front right support, and a front left mounting block engageable to a front left support, wherein the back support, the front right support and the front left support are securable to a stationary base surface and a front lateral fixture is couplable between the front right support and the front left support to receive a front right leg and a front left leg of the shooting rest; a back elongate support attached between a rear edge of the base plate and the back mounting block; a front right elongate support attached between a front right edge of the base plate and the front right mounting block; and a front left elongate support attached between a left front edge of the base plate and the front left mounting block, wherein the shooting rest stabilizer is configured to resist movement of the shooting rest in response to firing of a firearm or weapon supported by the shooting rest.

2. The shooting rest stabilizer system of claim 1, further comprising: a back clamp attached to the back mounting block and vertically adjustable and selectively engageable to the back support that extends vertically upward; a front right clamp attached to the front right mounting block and vertically adjustable and selectively engageable to the front right support that extends vertically

upward; and a front left clamp attached to the front left mounting block and vertically adjustable and selectively engageable to the front left support that extends vertically upward.

3. The shooting rest stabilizer system of claim 1, wherein each of the back elongate support, the front right elongate support, and the front left elongate support of the shooting rest stabilizer are vertically pivotably attached to the base plate to facilitate positioning of the base plate above the back mounting block, the front right mounting, and the front left mounting.

4. The shooting rest stabilizer system of claim 1, wherein each of the back elongate support, the front right elongate support, and the front left elongate support of the shooting rest stabilizer comprise a length adjustment mechanism that is a linearly expandable and compressible to impart a stabilizing force on the base plate.

5. The shooting rest stabilizer system of claim 1, wherein each of the back elongate support, the front right elongate support, and the front left elongate support of the shooting rest stabilizer comprise a telescoping length adjustment mechanism that is selectively longitudinally adjustable to accommodate spacing between the base plate and a corresponding one of the base support, the front right support and the front left support and selectively engageable to a fixed length for use.

6. The shooting rest stabilizer system of claim 1, further comprising: a unitary shoot rest mount platform comprising the back support, the front right support and the front left support, and a connecting structure attached to the back support, the front right support and the front left support.

7. The shooting rest stabilizer system of claim 6, wherein the unitary shooting rest mount platform comprising at least one ground engaging member that secures a corresponding one of the base support, the front right support, and the front left support to the stationary base surface.

8. The shooting rest stabilizer system of claim 6, wherein the unitary shooting rest mount platform comprises at least one truck bed fixture engageable to a truck bed to secure the shooting rest stabilizer system directly to a truck vehicle and indirectly to the stationary base surface.

9. The shooting rest stabilizer system of claim 6, wherein the unitary shooting rest mount platform comprises: a front right ground support attachable to the front right support and positionable on the stationary base surface; a front left ground support attachable to the front left support and positionable on the stationary base surface; and a back hitch drawbar engageable to a vehicle hitch to secure the shooting rest stabilizer system directly to a vehicle and indirectly to the stationary base surface.

10. The shooting rest stabilizer system of claim 6, wherein the unitary shooting rest mount platform comprises: a background support attachable to the back support and positionable on the stationary base surface; and a front lateral fixture engageable to a bench to secure the shooting rest stabilizer system indirectly to the stationary base surface.
